

Murad Zeynalli

Department of Economics
3021 Farmer School of Business
Miami University
Oxford, OH 45056

Work Email: zeynalm@miamioh.edu
Personal Email: muradzeynalli5@gmail.com
Phone: +1 (225) 371-1532
Personal Website: mzeynalli1.github.io

EMPLOYMENT	Miami University , Department of Economics Visiting Assistant Professor	Oxford, OH 2025 - Present
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EDUCATION	Louisiana State University Ph.D. in Economics Dissertation Title: <i>“Essays in Labor and Immigration Economics”</i> Chair: Dr. Daniel Keniston Graduate Certificate in Econometrics M.S. in Economics Baku Engineering University B.A. in Economics (<i>Summa Cum Laude</i>)	Baton Rouge, LA 2025 2022 2021 Baku, Azerbaijan 2019
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FIELDS OF INTEREST	Primary: Labor Economics, Economics of Immigration Secondary: Industrial Organization
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WORKING PAPERS	“Human Capital and Industrial Reallocation” [Job Market Paper] <i>Under Review at Labour Economics</i> Abstract: The skill composition of the local workforce is pivotal to the location and expansion of industries. Yet, its role in reshaping industrial structure remains less understood, since workforce skills and local production patterns evolve jointly. This paper studies how exogenous shifts in county human capital distribution affect employment and establishment shares of industries with different workforce education profiles. I construct education-specific instruments using a two-step ancestry-based strategy that predicts county ancestry stocks from historical origin-by-destination immigration patterns over 1860-2010 and maps them into working-age populations by educational attainment for 1970-2010. Relative to low-skill population share, one-percentage-point increases in medium- and high-skill shares raise employment share of high-skill industries by 0.18 and 0.54 percentage points and reduce its low-skill counterpart by 0.39 and 0.32 percentage points, respectively. Establishment shares exhibit similar reallocation. Positive responses arise in nontradable sectors, whereas contractions occur primarily in tradable industries. A decomposition of changes in county mean schooling attributes 27 percent of the adjustment to between-industry reallocation and 73 percent to within-industry upgrading. A CES model with imperfect substitution across skill groups and sectoral differences in skill intensity provides a benchmark for the between-industry response. The findings establish industrial composition as an important margin through which local labor markets adjust to changes in relative skill supply. “Assessing the Effects of Establishment Entry on Competition and Variable Profits” (with Joshua Scott and Eddy Junarsin) <i>Under Review at the Journal of Industry, Trade and Competition</i> Summary: We estimate the effect of retail entry on incumbent profits in Washington’s recreational cannabis market, combining seed-to-sale transaction data with instruments built from the state’s license allocation rules and the 2016 expansion of retail license caps. One additional retailer in a market reduces incumbent monthly variable profits by 4.2 percent, with the adjustment operating through quantities rather than prices. Effects are concentrated in jurisdictions that were already near their license caps before the expansion, indicating that entry matters most where regulation had suppressed local competition.
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“Holy Work: How Religiosity Shapes Local Labor Market Outcomes” (with *Mary Peshoff*)

Summary: We examine the causal effect of religious composition on US local labor markets, using quasi-random variation in historical immigration from 1850 to 2010 combined with origin-specific religiosity to isolate exogenous shifts in the religious makeup of commuting zones over 1940-2010. Relative to the unaffiliated share, larger Protestant, Orthodox Christian, and other religious shares reduce employment and marriage rates, while a larger Jewish share raises employment, college attainment, and mean income. Effects differ substantially by gender, with female labor force participation falling across nearly all denominational shares.

“Firm Creation under DACA”

(Supported by the Institute for Humane Studies: Grant No. IHS020545)

Summary: I study how the 2012 Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) program affected establishment entry, exit, and workforce composition, exploiting variation in pre-treatment policy exposure across sectors and commuting zones in a triple-difference design. DACA raises establishment entry by 2.4 percent in more exposed sectors and temporarily lowers exit rates, consistent with market expansion and entrepreneurship among newly authorized workers. The native employment share rises by 2.1 percentage points while the ineligible undocumented share falls by a comparable amount, indicating labor reallocation without displacement of native workers, with effects concentrated in low- and medium-skill sectors.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Learning to Set Prices During Recurring Demand Spikes” (with *Joshua Scott and Eddy Junarsin*) – *Draft Coming Soon!*

Summary: This paper studies how retailers adjust prices during a predictable, recurring demand spike in a newly legal market. Retail prices fall sharply on the event day, while quantities sold and revenue increase, and these markdowns become more widespread across retailers over time. The results document the emergence and diffusion of promotional pricing across the market.

“The Effect of Managerial Risk Preferences on Capital Structure Decisions” (with *Joshua Scott and Eddy Junarsin*)

“Weather Shocks, Violence, and Skill-Based Emigration from Mexico”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Miami University

ECO 201: Principles of Microeconomics (4 sections)	Fall 2026
ECO 202: Principles of Macroeconomics (1 section, online)	Summer 2026
ECO 202: Principles of Macroeconomics (3 sections)	Spring 2026
ECO 202: Principles of Macroeconomics (4 sections)	Fall 2025

Louisiana State University

<u>Course Instructor</u>	Fall 2022 - Spring 2025
ECON 2010: Principles of Macroeconomics (2 sections per semester)	
ECON 2010: Principles of Macroeconomics (1 section, online)	Summer 2024
Award: <i>Excellence in Teaching Award</i>	Fall 2024
Student Recognition: <i>Communication Across the Curriculum Student Recognition</i>	Fall 2023

<u>Tutorial Instructor</u>	Fall 2020 - Spring 2022
ECON 2030: Economic Principles (4 sections per semester, hybrid)	

<u>Teaching Assistant</u>	Fall 2019 - Spring 2020
ECON 4710: Aggregate Economic Analysis	
ECON 2035: Money, Banking, and Macroeconomic Activity	
ECON 2011: Principles of Macroeconomics (Honors)	

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Department of Oceanography and Coastal Sciences, LSU	Summer 2023
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Project: “The Effects of Hazards and Disaster Events on Migration to Inform Coastal Decision-Making and Restoration in Louisiana”
(Supported by the US Department of Treasury under the RESTORE Act)

AWARDS, GRANTS, & SCHOLARSHIPS	Teaching Award and Student Recognition		
	Excellence in Teaching Award, LSU		2024
	Communication Across the Curriculum Student Recognition, LSU		2023
	Other Grants and Awards		
	Research Grant (No. IHS020545), Institute for Humane Studies (IHS)		2026
	Professional Development Fund (x2), Miami University		2025 - 2026
	Graduate Assistantship, LSU		2019 - 2025
	T.J. Moran Superior Graduate Student Support Fund, LSU (x2)		2024
	Graduate Student Association Travel Award, LSU (x3)		2024
	Travel Award, Department of Economics, LSU		2023 & 2024
CONFERENCES & SEMINARS	Scholarships		
	Summer School Scholarship, <i>Mexico</i>		2024
	DAAD Master ERP Scholarship, <i>Germany</i>		2019-2021
	Full Undergraduate Scholarship, <i>Azerbaijan</i>		2014-2019
	2026:	Migration & Organizations Conference, The Wharton School, <i>Philadelphia, PA</i> Invited Seminar, University of Cincinnati, <i>Cincinnati, OH</i>	
	2025:	APPAM Fall Research Conference (47th), <i>Seattle, WA</i> Brown Bag, Miami Department of Economics, <i>Oxford, OH</i>	
	2024:	SEA Annual Meeting (94th), <i>Washington, DC</i> Summer School (3rd), “Economics of Migration,” <i>Mexico City, Mexico</i> EEA-ESEM (39th-76th), Erasmus University, <i>Rotterdam, Netherlands</i> Brown Bag, LSU Department of Economics, <i>Baton Rouge, LA</i>	
	2023:	SEA Annual Meeting (93rd), <i>New Orleans, LA</i> Brown Bag, LSU Department of Economics, <i>Baton Rouge, LA</i>	
	2022:	Brown Bag, LSU Department of Economics, <i>Baton Rouge, LA</i>	
	2021:	Brown Bag, LSU Department of Economics, <i>Baton Rouge, LA</i>	
PROFESSIONAL & DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE	Participating Instructor , Ohio Economic Education Project (OEEP)		
	Department Representative at the “Destination LSU: Academic Reception”		
	2022; 2024; 2025		
	Reviewer		
MEMBERSHIPS	Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, <i>New Orleans</i>		
	American Economic Association, Society of Labor Economists, European Association of Labour Economists, European Economic Association, Association for Public Policy and Management		
SKILLS	Computer: Stata, R, Python, EViews, L ^A T _E X		
	Languages: Azerbaijani (Native), English (Fluent), Turkish (Fluent), German (Basic)		
REFERENCES			
	Daniel Keniston	Areendam Chanda	Scott Abrahams
	Associate Professor of Economics	Professor of Economics	Assistant Professor of Economics
	Department of Economics	Department of Economics	Department of Economics
	Louisiana State University	Louisiana State University	Louisiana State University
	Phone: (225) 578-3807	Phone: (225) 578-5211	Phone: (225) 578-5211
	Email: dkeniston@lsu.edu	Email: achanda@lsu.edu	Email: sabrahams@lsu.edu

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